

Boston, MA
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Alexander Gharibian

Senior Software Engineer

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EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

Spotify

Boston, MA

Senior Engineer, Agentic Recommendations

February 2025 — Present

- Architected the foundation for how agentic recommendations work across Spotify, letting users reshape their homepage in real-time through natural-language prompts; launched as Taste Profile ([announced by the Co-CEO at SXSW](#))
- Led strategy, prototyping, and productionization across **3 0-to-1 agentic workstreams**, validated through 5 live user experiments
- Built and shipped an agentic homepage carousel that turns a user's natural-language prompt into personalized recommendations, using an LLM to classify intent and orchestrate concurrent calls to Spotify search and recommendation tools; results stream at **3x the baseline rate**, powered by Gemini, Braintrust, LangChain, gRPC, and Pub/Sub

Senior Engineer, Homepage Personalization

February 2024 — February 2025

- Drove rollout of Spotify's [redesigned feed-based homepage](#) as engineering point of contact for Home Personalization, coordinating cross-org A/B tests and go-to-market strategy to launch to **500M+ MAUs**
- Designed and shipped a next-gen gRPC-based homepage ranker backend that cut infrastructure costs by **80%+** on Spotify's second-costliest GKE namespace while scoring and ranking hundreds of candidates per user at **sub-250ms p99 latency**, saving **\$1M+/year**
- Lifted below-the-fold consumption **3%** and podcast discovery **9%** with a new ML ranking model, driving tens of millions of incremental streams at Spotify's scale

Engineer II, Homepage Personalization

May 2022 — February 2024

- Authored two cross-org RFCs defining implementation strategies to unify Spotify's homepage ranking across mobile and non-mobile platforms, driving adoption discussions with leadership across Home and partner product orgs

Capital One

McLean, VA

Senior Associate Software Engineer

July 2020 — May 2022

- Led a team of 3 to ship Secured Card balance-check and security-deposit-payment flows in Capital One's call-center agent website
- Built Go-based AWS Lambda orchestration APIs powering credit-limit increases for millions of Secured Card customers
- Cut Secured Card test-data setup from **15 minutes to 30 seconds** by building an automated end-to-end framework that provisions pre-conditioned accounts and integrates with CI/CD pipelines

Associate Software Engineer

August 2019 — July 2020

- Saved **\$10M/year** by co-developing the core logic of an AWS Lambda, EMR, and Spark-powered decision engine that adjusts business credit card APRs from payment behavior, replacing a legacy on-prem system
- Shipped a Java Spring Boot API and Vue.js-based call-center tile surfacing remaining statement balance, unlocking a new bill-payment path for customers

Red Hat

Westford, MA

Performance Engineering Intern

Summer 2018

- Built an OpenCV + TensorFlow handwritten-digit demo for *Machine Learning Container Creator* (MLCC), a one-command CLI for installing ML packages into Docker containers on Red Hat OSes; presented to Red Hat employees and executives

Software Engineering Intern

Summer 2017

- Built the *fetch* feature for [Linchpin](#) (open-source multi-cloud provisioning CLI/Python API, 225k+ downloads), enabling users to pull remote topology configurations locally and restore prior sessions

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Programming Languages	Java, Go, Python, C, C++, Shell, JavaScript, SQL
Technologies	GCP, AWS, Docker, Kubernetes, gRPC, Pub/Sub, Bigtable, BigQuery, Lambda, EMR, Node.js
LLMs	Claude (Opus and Sonnet), Gemini (Flash and Pro), GPT
Agentic Tooling	Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, Braintrust, LangChain
Certifications	AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate
Spoken Languages	English, Armenian
Interests	Guitar, Piano, Skiing, Rowing, Cycling

EDUCATION

Purdue University

West Lafayette, IN

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

May 2019

Concentration in Systems Programming and Software Engineering

Certificate in Entrepreneurship